KHADI TIRANGA YATRA

KVIC celebrated India's 75th Independence Day celebrations with much fanfare in different events from Kashmir to Mumbai. A highlight of this was a unique Khadi Tiranga Yatra which was taken out in Varanasi on 13 August, 2022. Around 20,000 people participated in the two-kilometre Yatra led by Chairman of KVIC Shri Manoj Kumar, who made an appeal to everyone to hoist the tricolour in homes and contribute to fulfilling PM Modiji's dream of 'Har Ghar Tiranga'. The Yatra, taken out by the Khadi Parivar, consisted of a large number of officials and employees associated with KVIC. They were accompanied by weavers and artisans as well as school students.

KHADI UTSAV

On August 27, the PM inaugurated Khadi Utsav in Ahmedabad under the auspices of Gujarat Rajya Khadi Gramodyog Board. Modiji also tried his hands on the charkha as part of the Azadi Ka Amrit Mahotsav. Khadi became the symbol of the country's self-respect during the freedom movement. Khadi that broke the chains of slavery during colonial rule, can also become an inspiration to make India developed and self-reliant, Modiji said. The PM was greeted in a unique way by 7,500 women, who were spinning charkhas simultaneously when he arrived. Referring to the special event, Modiji said, "Your hands on the charkha are weaving the future of India. This bank of the Sabarmati has become blessed today, as 7,500 sisters and daughters have created new history by spinning the thread of strength together."

The event also showcased 22 charkhas from different generations since the 1920s, in an exhibition called 'Evolution of Charkhas'. It featured charkhas used during the freedom struggle to modern-day charkhas featuring the latest innovations.

HAR GHAR TIRANGA

'Har Ghar Tiranga' was a campaign under the aegis of Azadi Ka Amrit Mahotsav to encourage people to bring the Tiranga or Indian tri-colour home and to hoist it to mark the 75th year of India's Independence. The campaign was a huge boost to the sale of khadi flags this year. As a result of this campaign, Khadi Gramodyog saw a whopping 75 percent increase in demand for flags. The campaign aimed to hoist 20 crore national flags atop people's houses all across the country from August 13 to 15. Although a variety of materials were allowed, the first preference of buyers was still hand-spun and handwoven khadi flags. Not only citizens, orders poured in from institutions and organisations as well.

OTHER DEVELOPMENTS

Chairman, KVIC Shri Manoj Kumar inaugurated 72 Units under PMEGP on 17 September, 2022 at the KVIC Office, Mumbai. He also disbursed Margin Money Subsidy of Rs 27.43 crore to 720 PMEGP beneficiaries. These units are expected to generate self-employment for 5,760 artisans. On 21 September, 2022, Shri Manoj Kumar visited PMTC, Pampore and Srinagar where he distributed 200 electric potter wheels to pottery artisans and 12 Hydra Pulper Machines to papier-mache artisans. He also distributed 40 agarbatti machines to Jammu artisans. KVIC put up a kiosk on Kartavya Path, New Delhi from 17 September to 2 October, 2022 to promote khadi and inspire people to use it.

MANDATE OF KVIC

Khadi and Village Industries Commission has three main objectives which guide its functioning. These are:

- **The Social Objective** - Providing employment in rural areas
- **The Economic Objective** - Providing saleable articles
- **The Wider Objective** - Creating self-reliance amongst people and building up a strong rural community spirit.

The commission achieves these objectives through various schemes and programmes.

KVIC also works on building reserves of raw materials and implements for producers, creation of common service facilities for processing of raw materials as semi-finished goods and provisions of facilities for marketing of KVI products apart from training of artisans and encouragement of co- operative efforts amongst them.

KVIC promotes research in production techniques in the khadi sector. Further, it provides financial assistance to institutions and individuals for development and operation of khadi and village industries.

THE RELEVANCE OF KHADI & VILLAGE INDUSTRIES

Khadi & Village Industries are labour intensive. In the aftermath of industrialisation and the automating of all operations, textile and rural industries are uniquely tailored to a workforce surplus country like India. Another advantage of Khadi & Village Industries is that they require little to no start-up capital.

SOME KVIC SCHEMES

PMEGP Scheme (Prime Minister's Employment Generation Programme): PMEGP is a credit-linked subsidy scheme for developing new micro, medium and small firms and creating employment opportunities. KVIC serves as the main agency for PMEGP implementation. The loan amount of Rs 25 lakh has been increased to 50 lakh and Rs. 20 lakh for service sector is benefitting a lot of people.

Honey Mission: KVIC developed the Honey (Bee) Mission to assist beekeeping and create job opportunities in beekeeping states. One of the goals of the SFURTI Scheme is to promote scientific beekeeping practices.

Workshed Scheme for Khadi Artisans: The KVIC scheme provides financial help to BPL khadi artisans to construct work sheds. KVIC ensures that financial aid provided under the scheme is used to benefit the artisans.

Khadi Reform and Development Programme: KRDP strives to provide rural artisans with a low-cost way to generate money in their households. Traditional village industries such as handmade paper, honey, cosmetics, herbal health, agro-food processing and leather are also supported.

Interest Subsidy Eligibility Certificate: Banks can obtain loans at a reduced interest rate through the KVIC scheme if they have an Interest Subsidy Eligibility Certificate issued by KVIC.

